

 VANCOUVER ISLAND UNIVERSITY	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	Page: 1 of 5 Final
TITLE: ACC-013 Fish Disposal		
ISSUE DATE: June 13, 2013		
APPROVED BY: Vancouver Island University Animal Care Committee – Date: 03-25-2014		

1.0 PREAMBLE:

On occasion fish mortality will occur. To maintain the health status of tank populations of fish, moribund or deceased fish must be removed daily or upon the immediate notice of fish care personnel. Dead fish may harbor pathogens and to ensure that these pathogens do not infect other populations of fish or contaminate equipment which may come into contact with fish, carcasses must be disposed in an appropriate manner.

2.0 PURPOSE:

To describe fish disposal procedures for normal fish mortalities. For procedures in the event of infectious outbreak, see SOP - "Fish Health Diagnostics and Veterinary Consultation".

3.0 SCOPE:

In the event of fish mortality, standard practices shall be undertaken to ensure that any associated potential pathogens are contained and that the carcass is properly disposed.

4.0 RESPONSIBILITIES:

Principal Investigators and/or Responsible Managers have overall responsibility for: ensuring that personnel are aware of and understand this policy/procedure.

All Personnel that work under Animal Use Protocols (AUPs) that cite this SOP are responsible for:

- a. Familiarizing themselves with this policy/procedure;
- b. Obtaining training for this procedure prior to conducting the procedure (if unsupervised).

5.0 APPROVED PROCEDURE:

5.1 Title of procedure:

Fish Disposal

5.2 Definition of terms used in the Standard Operating Procedure

Not applicable

 VANCOUVER ISLAND UNIVERSITY	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	Page: 2 of 5 Final
TITLE: ACC-013 Fish Disposal		
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5.3 Supplies and Equipment:

Dip net for fish removal
Disinfection materials for equipment
Ziploc™ or garbage bag

5.4 Pre-Procedural Preparations and Examination of Animal:

All mortalities should be visually inspected for cause of death (see SOP - "Fish Health Diagnostics and Veterinary Consultation").

5.5 Procedure

Fish care personnel disposal responsibilities:

1. Remove dead fish using a dip net assigned to the tank.
2. Place net in a Net Disinfection Bucket. The disinfection bucket should contain a disinfection agent such as Ovadine, Virkon or Peroxyguard (see SOP - "Equipment Disinfection and Hand Hygiene").
3. Place dead fish in a plastic sandwich bag or large freezer bag and wrap closed.
4. Place fish in freezer at Tank Farm #1, adjacent to Room 106, or in the freezer at Chase River Hatchery.
 - VIU Technicians will contact Nanaimo Regional Landfill at (250) 722-2044 to arrange disposal as "controlled waste".

(optional) - Disposal at Island Processing Company (900 Maughan Road, Nanaimo, BC)

- Immediately place carcass into clear bag (fish bag, Ziplock(TM))
- Flash freeze fish carcass in mort freezer in Tank Farm 1.
- Alert Technicians as freezer approaches full.
- VIU Technicians will contact Island Processing Company to arrange disposal at (250) 722-4770. (Note: mortalities resulting from outbreak of infectious disease cannot be disposed at the Island Processing Company (rendering).

	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	Page: 3 of 5 Final
TITLE: ACC-013 Fish Disposal		
ISSUE DATE: June 13, 2013		
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5.6 Post- procedural Follow-Up:

Prior to disposal (dumpster located outside Environmental Science Building #370, Nanaimo Regional Landfill, or Islan Processing Company), precaution will be taken in handling organic/biologic waste materials (see SOPs - "Biosecurity and Biocontainment: Introduction", "Biosecurity: Equipment Disinfection and Hand Hygiene").

5.7 Safety Equipment and Procedures:

Disposal exam gloves should be worn when handling fish carcasses.

5.8 Non-Conformance:

Any personnel determined to be improperly disposing of fish will be considered in violation of the associated AUP and will be subject to VIU disciplinary procedure outlined in VIU Procedure 31.01.001 – Animal Care Committee - Section 5.

The VIU Animal Care Committee is authorized by the President of Vancouver Island University to halt any procedure where the committee considers that unnecessary or unforeseen pain or distress is being experienced by an animal, or where use deviates significantly from an approved protocol. Authority extends to humane destruction of the animal if it is considered that pain or distress of the animal cannot be alleviated. The institutional veterinarian is empowered to take the foregoing actions without reference to the researcher or the committee if his/her professional judgement so warrants. (Section 2 of VIU Procedure 31.01.001).

6.0 RECORDS

Records to be completed include:

Fish mortalities will be recorded in daily husbandry records, reflected in total number and weight.

7.0 FORMS

Forms to be completed include:

Not applicable

 VANCOUVER ISLAND UNIVERSITY	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	Page: 4 of 5 Final
TITLE: ACC-013 Fish Disposal		
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8.0 REFERENCES:

- Dave Leitch, Supervisor, Cedar Solid Waste Facility, City of Nanaimo (Pers. Com).
www.city.nanaimo.bc.ca/b_clerk/bylaws
- SOP Biosecurity and Biocontainment: Introduction
- SOP Biosecurity: Equipment Disinfection and Hand Hygiene
- SOP Fish Health Diagnostics and Veterinary Consultation

9.0 AUTHOR CONTACT INFORMATION:

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 VANCOUVER ISLAND UNIVERSITY	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	Page: 5 of 5 Final
TITLE: ACC-013 Fish Disposal		
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REVISION LOG

Revision Date	Authority	Reviser	Revision Details